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Sesame-Scallion Beef

with Pickled Ginger, Bok Choy, and Long Life Noodles

Pickling your own ginger may seem daunting, but we're here to demystify the technique. By slicing the root into thin strips and boiling it with rice wine vinegar, honey, and soy sauce until tender, we're creating a satisfyingly sweet, tangy, crunchy garnish for the saucy beef, bok choy, and chewy long life noodles. Plus, you'll get bonus points for impressing your dinner companion.

25-35 minutes 980 calories per serving

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Ingredients

- 8 ounces baby bok choy, divided
- 2 scallions, divided
- ½ ounce ginger
- 2 cloves garlic
- 1 packet honey
- ¼ cup rice wine vinegar, divided
- 3 tablespoons soy sauce, divided
- 12 ounces ground beef
- 1½ tablespoons sesame oil, divided
- 1 tablespoon sesame seeds
- 8 ounces long life noodles

You'll Need

canola oil
kosher salt
black pepper
10" large pot
6" small pot
12" large pan

Recipe Tips

Be sure to read through the entire recipe before you begin cooking. Trust us—you'll be glad you did!

Pouring the fat down the drain may damage your pipes—instead, pour it into a heatproof container once it's cooled slightly, and dispose in the garbage.

Sesame seeds can burn quickly, so be sure to keep an eye on them as they cook.

USDA recommends cooking ground beef to 160°F.

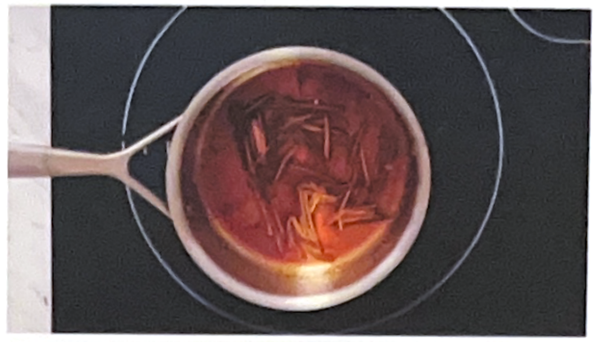
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1. Prepare Ingredients

Halve **bok choy** lengthwise and rinse thoroughly—it tends to hide a lot of dirt between its leaves. Cut crosswise into ½-inch pieces, keeping bulbs and leaves separate. Rinse **scallions**, trim and discard roots, and thinly slice, keeping whites and light greens separate from dark greens. Trim and discard skin of **ginger** and thinly slice, then slice again crosswise into matchsticks. Thinly slice **garlic**.



2. Pickle Ginger

Bring a large pot of water to a boil over high heat. In a separate small pot, combine **honey**, **3 tablespoons rice wine vinegar**, **1 teaspoon soy sauce**, and **ginger**, and bring to a boil over medium-high heat. Cook, stirring, until liquid is syrupy, 5-6 minutes. Then, remove pot from heat and set aside to pickle until ready to serve.



3. Brown Beef

Pat **beef** dry with paper towel. Heat **½ tablespoon canola oil** in a large pan over medium-high heat. Add **beef** and season with **½ teaspoon salt** and **pepper** as desired. Cook, breaking up, until browned, 6-7 minutes. Using a slotted spoon, transfer **beef** to a bowl and set aside. Discard excess fat (see Recipe Tip), reserving pan for the next step.



4. Season Beef

Heat **half of sesame oil** in pan from beef over medium heat. When oil is shimmering, add **sesame seeds** (see Recipe Tip), **bok choy bulbs**, **scallion whites and light greens**, and **garlic**. Sauté, stirring, until softened, 5 minutes. Add **bok choy leaves** and **¼ teaspoon salt**. Stir to wilt, 1 minute. Return **beef** to pan with bok choy, and add **remaining rice wine vinegar**. Cook to warm through, 1 minute more. Remove pan from heat.



5. Prepare Noodles

Season boiling water generously with **salt**. Stir in **long life noodles**. Cook until al dente, 2-3 minutes. Drain and rinse under cold water for 30 seconds to stop cooking, then return to pot, off heat. Add **remaining soy sauce**, **remaining sesame oil**, and **half of scallion dark greens** to pot with noodles and toss to combine.



6. Plate Sesame-Scallion Beef

Drain **pickled ginger**, discarding liquid. Divide **long life noodles** between serving bowls. Spoon over **beef and vegetables**, pouring over any **remaining sauce** from pan. Garnish with **ginger** and **remaining scallion dark greens**. Taste and add **salt** and **pepper** as desired. Dig in!

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